PEW RESEARCH CENTER FOR THE PEOPLE & THE PRESS
DECEMBER 2011 POLITICAL SURVEY
FINAL TOPLINE
December 7-11, 2011
N=1521

ASK ALL:
Q.1 Do you approve or disapprove of the way Barack Obama is handling his job as President? **[IF DK ENTER AS DK. IF DEPENDS PROBE ONCE WITH:** Overall do you approve or disapprove of the way Barack Obama is handling his job as President? **IF STILL DEPENDS ENTER AS DK]**

	Approve	Dis-approve	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref		Approve	Dis-approve	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	46	43	11	Jun 16-20, 2010	48	43	9
Nov 9-14, 2011	46	46	8	May 6-9, 2010	47	42	11
Sep 22-Oct 4, 2011	43	48	9	Apr 21-26, 2010	47	42	11
Aug 17-21, 2011	43	49	7	Apr 8-11, 2010	48	43	9
Jul 20-24, 2011	44	48	8	Mar 10-14, 2010	46	43	12
Jun 15-19, 2011	46	45	8	Feb 3-9, 2010	49	39	12
May 25-30, 2011	52	39	10	Jan 6-10, 2010	49	42	10
May 5-8, 2011	50	39	11	Dec 9-13, 2009	49	40	11
May 2, 2011	56	38	6	Oct 28-Nov 8, 2009	51	36	13
Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	47	45	8	Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	52	36	12
Feb 22-Mar 1, 2011	51	39	10	Sep 10-15, 2009	55	33	13
Feb 2-7, 2011	49	42	9	Aug 20-27, 2009	52	37	12
Jan 5-9, 2011	46	44	10	Aug 11-17, 2009	51	37	11
Dec 1-5, 2010	45	43	13	Jul 22-26, 2009	54	34	12
Nov 4-7, 2010	44	44	12	Jun 10-14, 2009	61	30	9
Oct 13-18, 2010	46	45	9	Apr 14-21, 2009	63	26	11
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010	47	44	9	Mar 31-Apr 6, 2009	61	26	13
Jul 21-Aug 5, 2010	47	41	12	Mar 9-12, 2009	59	26	15
Jun 8-28, 2010	48	41	11	Feb 4-8, 2009	64	17	19

ASK ALL:
Q.2 Do you approve or disapprove of the job the **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]** are doing? **[IF DK ENTER AS DK. IF DEPENDS PROBE ONCE WITH:** Overall do you approve or disapprove of the job the **[ITEM]** are doing? **IF STILL DEPENDS ENTER AS DK]. [INTERVIEWER INSTRUCTION: REPEAT FULL QUESTION FOR NEXT ITEM]**

	Approve	Disapprove	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Republican leaders in Congress			
Dec 7-11, 2011	21	68	11
Nov 9-14, 2011	23	67	10
Aug 17-21, 2011	22	69	9
Jul 20-24, 2011	25	66	10
Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	30	61	9
Feb 24-27, 2011	36	45	19
Jan 5-9, 2011[1]	34	43	22
Nov 4-7, 2010	41	37	22
Sep 30-Oct 3, 2010	24	60	16
Jul 22-25, 2010	33	53	14
Jun 16-20, 2010	31	55	14
Apr 8-11, 2010	30	56	14
Mar 10-14, 2010	25	59	16
Jan 6-10, 2010	27	57	16
Dec 9-13, 2009	29	51	20
Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	24	60	17
Jun 10-14, 2009	29	56	15

[1] Question wording for Nov. 4-7, 2010, and Jan. 5-9, 2011, was: "Do you approve or disapprove of Republican congressional leaders' policies and plans for the future?"

Q.2 CONTINUED…

	Approve	Disapprove	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Mar 9-12, 2009	28	51	21
Feb 4-8, 2009	34	51	15
Early October, 2006	33	56	11
June, 2006	30	53	17
March, 2006	32	50	18
January, 2006	33	52	15
Early November, 2005	33	50	17
Early October, 2005	32	52	16
Mid-September, 2005	36	49	15
Mid-May, 2005	35	50	15
Mid-March, 2005	39	44	17
Early February, 2004	41	42	17
January, 2003	48	37	15
June, 2002	50	34	16
May, 2002	49	34	17
February, 2002	56	24	20
Early September, 2001	43	39	18
June, 2001	40	40	20
May, 2001	45	36	19
April, 2001	45	30	25
January, 2001	43	36	21
July, 2000	36	46	18
May, 2000	40	42	18
March, 2000	38	43	19
February, 2000	40	43	17
January, 2000	39	41	20
December, 1999	38	42	20
October, 1999	34	50	16
Late September, 1999	34	46	20
August, 1999	40	44	16
July, 1999	36	45	19
June, 1999	37	46	17
May, 1999	38	44	18
March, 1999	38	47	15
February, 1999	37	51	12
January, 1999	38	50	12
Early December, 1998	38	49	13
November, 1998	41	48	11
Early September, 1998	44	37	19
Early August, 1998	43	37	20
June, 1998	42	38	20
May, 1998	40	41	19
April, 1998	41	40	19
March, 1998	43	39	18
January, 1998	43	41	16
November, 1997	41	43	16
August, 1997	42	44	14
June, 1997	33	50	17
May, 1997	40	44	16
April, 1997	40	44	16
February, 1997	44	42	14
January, 1997	38	47	15
December, 1996[2]	40	43	17
July, 1996	38	48	14
June, 1996	36	50	14
April, 1996	39	46	15
March, 1996	35	51	14

[2] From December, 1994, through December, 1996, the question was worded: “As best you can tell, do you approve or disapprove of the policies and proposals of the Republican leaders in Congress?”.

Q.2 CONTINUED…

	Approve	Disapprove	(VOL.) DK/Ref
February, 1996	33	53	14
January, 1996	36	54	10
October, 1995	36	51	13
September, 1995	36	50	14
August, 1995	38	45	17
June, 1995	41	45	14
April, 1995	44	43	13
March, 1995	43	39	18
December, 1994	52	28	20
b. Democratic leaders in Congress			
Dec 7-11, 2011	31	58	11
Nov 9-14, 2011	30	61	9
Aug 17-21, 2011	29	63	9
Jul 20-24, 2011	30	60	10
Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	31	60	9
Feb 24-27, 2011	33	48	19
Sep 30-Oct 3, 2010	30	53	17
Jul 22-25, 2010	35	56	10
Jun 16-20, 2010	35	53	12
Apr 8-11, 2010	38	51	11
Mar 10-14, 2010	31	57	12
Jan 6-10, 2010	35	53	11
Dec 9-13, 2009	36	47	17
Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	33	53	15
Jun 10-14, 2009	42	45	13
Mar 9-12, 2009	47	35	18
Feb 4-8, 2009	48	38	14
August, 2008	31	58	11
January, 2008	31	53	16
November, 2007	35	50	15
October, 2007	31	54	15
July, 2007	33	54	13
June, 2007	34	49	17
April, 2007	36	43	21
March, 2007[3]	37	42	21
February, 2007	41	36	23
Mid-January, 2007	39	34	27
November, 2006[4]	50	21	29
Early October, 2006	35	53	12
June, 2006	32	50	18
March, 2006	34	46	20
January, 2006	34	48	18
Early November, 2005	36	44	20
Early October, 2005	32	48	20
Mid-September, 2005	36	45	19
Mid-May, 2005	39	41	20
Mid-March, 2005	37	44	19
Early February, 2004	38	42	20
June, 2002	47	36	17
May, 2002	42	37	21
February, 2002	49	30	21
Early September, 2001	49	30	21
June, 2001	50	28	22
December, 1994	52	28	20

[3] In March 2007 the question was worded: "Do you approve or disapprove of the policies and proposals of the Democratic leaders in Congress?".

[4] Question wording in November, 2006, and December, 1994, was: "As best you can tell, do you approve or disapprove of Democratic congressional leaders' policies and plans for the future?".

NO QUESTION 3

ASK ALL:
Now, I'd like to ask you about your hopes and fears for YOUR OWN future.

Q.4 First, please tell me in your own words, what are your main wishes and hopes for your future? What do you most hope for to be happy in your life? **[OPEN-END, RECORD VERBATIMS. PROBE FOR CLARITY ONLY. ACCEPT MULTIPLE RESPONSES BUT DO NOT PROBE FOR THEM. ACCEPT UP TO THREE RESPONSES.]**

Dec 7-11 2011		Dec 1996
46	**(NET) FINANCIAL**	**42**
16	Good job/Better job/Keep a job	
11	Sound economy/National economy improves	
10	Financial security/Having enough to get by	
5	Being able to retire/Comfortable retirement	
4	Wealth/Get money	
4	Continuation of Social Security/Medicare	
1	Economic policies	
1	Other financial/economic	
21	**(NET) FAMILY/CHILDREN**	**18**
11	Happiness/Stability/Health for family/children	
4	Job/career/financial success for children	
3	Having a family/Having children/grandchildren	
2	Education for children/grandchildren	
3	Other family/children	
16	**(NET) HEALTH**	**21**
14	Good health/A long life	
3	Good health care/Low medical/health care costs	
13	**(NET) QUALITY OF LIFE**	**6**
6	Happiness/Love/Friends/Comfort/Quality of life	
4	Success/Professional hopes	
3	Buy a house/Move to a better place	
7	**(NET) GOVERNMENT/POLITICS/NATION**	**4**
4	Politics/Leadership better/Political outcomes	
2	Country on track/return to past ways	
1	Smaller government	4
5	No wars/Peace/National Security	10
4	**(NET) EDUCATION**	**4**
3	Get an education/Finish school	
1	Better education in the country	
2	Help others in society	
2	Serve God/Be a good religious person	
1	Happy with current life/Don't need more	
1	Better world/country	
1	Immigration reform/Path to citizenship	
1	Morality/religion in public life	
1	People getting along	
1	Nothing	
5	Other	
6	Don't know	12

Total exceeds 100% because of multiple responses.

ASK ALL:

Q.5 And what are your main fears and worries about your own future? **[OPEN-END, RECORD VERBATIMS. PROBE FOR CLARITY ONLY. ACCEPT MULTIPLE RESPONSES BUT DO NOT PROBE FOR THEM. ACCEPT UP TO THREE RESPONSES.]**

Dec 7-11 2011		Dec 1996
50	**(NET) FINANCIAL**	**38**
15	No financial security/Not enough money	
14	Losing job/Not finding a job	
12	The economy	
5	Cuts in Social Security/Medicare benefits	
5	Not being able to afford to retire/Running out of money	
3	Homelessness/Loss of home	
1	National debt/deficit/government spending	
1	Economic policies	
1	Other financial/economic	
12	**(NET) HEALTH**	**14**
7	Illness/Poor health	
4	Not having health care/insurance/Cost of health care	
2	Death	
9	**(NET) GOVERNMENT/POLITICS/NATION**	**5**
4	Broken political system/Polarization/Political outcomes	
3	Direction of the country/government	
1	Government interference/overreach	
1	Loss of various rights/freedoms	
7	**(NET) FAMILY/CHILDREN**	**6**
5	Family not being happy/healthy/Something bad happening	
1	No jobs/career/education for children/grandchildren	
1	Not having a family/marriage/children	
3	**(NET) QUALITY OF LIFE**	**--**
2	Failing/Not being successful	
1	Not having quality of life	
3	War/Political unrest/Terrorism	4
1	Crime/Personal safety	
1	Worse world/country	
1	No immigration reform/No path to citizenship	
1	State of education in the country	
8	Other	
13	None/No worries	24
6	Don't know	2

Total exceeds 100% because of multiple responses.

ASK ALL:

Q.6 Imagine a ladder with steps numbered from 0 at the bottom to 10 at the top. Suppose the top of the ladder represents the best possible life for you; and the bottom, the worst possible life for you. On which step of the ladder do you feel you personally stand at the present time? You can name any number between 0 and 10. [5]

	High (8-10)	Medium (6-7)	Low (0-5)	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref	*Mean rating*
Dec 7-11, 2011	27	35	37	1	*6.2*
Pew SDT May, 2010	28	34	37	1	*6.2*
Pew SDT February, 2008	32	34	32	2	*6.4*
Pew SDT July, 2006	41	30	26	3	*6.8*
GAP May, 2005	40	29	30	1	*6.7*
February, 1999	43	31	25	1	*6.9*
February, 1998	48	31	21	*	*7.1*
October, 1997	47	31	22	*	*7.0*
December, 1996	37	33	29	1	*6.7*
February, 1989	31	35	34	*	*6.4*
May, 1987	33	36	30	1	*6.5*
Gallup: March, 1985	31	36	33	*	*6.4*
Gallup: August, 1979	34	31	33	2	*6.5*
Gallup: June, 1976	38	30	32	*	*6.7*
Gallup: April, 1974	36	28	36	*	*6.4*
Gallup: May, 1972	34	28	38	*	*6.4*
Gallup: January, 1971	34	30	34	2	*6.5*
Gallup: September, 1964	36	33	30	1	*6.7*

ASK ALL:

Q.7 And on which step would you say you stood five years ago? Zero is the worst possible life and 10 the best possible life.

	High (8-10)	Medium (6-7)	Low (0-5)	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref	*Mean rating*
Dec 7-11, 2011	36	26	36	2	*6.3*
Pew SDT May, 2010	39	27	33	2	*6.5*
Pew SDT February, 2008	32	28	38	2	*6.2*
Pew SDT July, 2006	31	26	40	3	*6.1*
GAP May, 2005	31	26	41	2	*6.1*
February, 1999	27	23	49	1	*5.7*
February, 1998	29	23	48	*	*5.9*
October, 1997	28	25	46	1	*5.9*
December, 1996	26	27	46	1	*5.8*
February, 1989	28	27	44	1	*6.0*
May, 1987	28	26	45	1	*5.8*
Gallup: March, 1985	25	27	48	*	*5.7*
Gallup: August, 1979	28	24	48	*	*5.8*
Gallup: June, 1976	29	22	49	*	*5.7*
Gallup: April, 1974	24	22	54	*	*5.4*
Gallup: May, 1972	24	23	53	*	*5.5*
Gallup: January, 1971	27	25	47	1	*5.8*
Gallup: September, 1964	28	24	47	1	*5.8*

[5] Additional trends for present, past, and future standing (Q7,Q8,Q9) also available from the Pew Global Attitudes Project. Trends shown were asked in similar contexts to the current poll.

ASK ALL:

Q.8 Just your best guess, on which step do you think you will stand in the future, say five years from now? Zero is the worst possible life and 10 is the best possible life.

	High (8-10)	Medium (6-7)	Low (0-5)	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref	*Mean rating*
Dec 7-11, 2011	50	18	24	7	*7.1*
Pew SDT May, 2010	52	16	24	9	*7.1*
Pew SDT February, 2008	58	15	17	10	*7.6*
Pew SDT July, 2006	60	13	14	13	*7.8*
GAP May, 2005	59	14	17	10	*7.7*
February, 1999	69	14	10	7	*8.2*
February, 1998	72	14	11	3	*8.2*
October, 1997	73	13	10	4	*8.2*
December, 1996	64	16	16	4	*7.7*
February, 1989	56	21	18	5	*7.4*
May, 1987	61	19	14	6	*7.7*
Gallup: March, 1985	59	19	16	6	*7.6*
Gallup: August, 1979	57	18	19	6	*7.5*
Gallup: June, 1976	60	18	14	8	*7.7*
Gallup: April, 1974	55	18	18	9	*7.4*
Gallup: May, 1972	58	17	16	9	*7.6*
Gallup: January, 1971	52	18	16	14	*7.5*
Gallup: September, 1964	57	22	11	10	*7.8*

ASK ALL:

Q.9 If you were asked to use one of these commonly used names for the social classes, which would you say you belong in? The upper class, upper-middle class, middle class, lower-middle class, or lower class?

Dec 7-11 2011		Mar 15-29 2011[6]	May 2010	Feb 2008
1	Upper class	2	2	2
15	Upper-middle class	17	18	19
46	Middle class	52	50	53
25	Lower-middle class	20	21	19
11	Lower class	7	8	6
2	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	2	1	1

NO QUESTIONS 10-11

[6] March 2011 and earlier questions were asked by Pew Social and Demographic Trends.

ASK ALL:

Q.12 What do you think is the most important problem facing the country today? **[RECORD VERBATIM RESPONSE. PROBE FOR CLARITY – DO NOT PROBE FOR ADDITIONAL MENTIONS. IF MORE THAN ONE MENTION, RECORD IN ORDER OF MENTION]**

Dec 7-11 2011		May 11[7]	Jan 11	Aug 10	Feb 10	Aug 09	Feb 09	Early Oct 08	Jul 08	Jan 08	Sep 07	Jan 07
21	Unemployment/Lack of jobs	26	35	27	31	19	31	9	5	5	3	5
19	Economy (general)	28	27	35	24	27	53	55	39	20	10	5
10	Dissatisfaction with gov't/politics/ Obama	4	9	9	5	5	5	4	3	6	7	8
9	Deficit/National debt/Balanced budget/Gov't spending	10	11	3	11	6	4	1	1	2	1	1
4	Partisanship/Parties/Gridlock	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--
4	Health care/costs/accessibility	6	9	4	13	20	3	4	3	10	7	8
4	War/War in Iraq/War in Afghan.	5	3	3	4	5	3	11	17	27	37	42
3	Education/schools/affording education	2	3	1	1	2	1	--	4	4	3	4
2	Morality/Ethics/Family values	1	2	4	3	3	1	1	3	2	3	3
2	Finances/money	5	2	2	--	--	--	4	--	--	--	--
2	Poverty/Hunger/Starvation	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	1	3	3	3
2	Lack of leadership	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--
2	Taxes	1	1	1	1	--	--	1	--	2	1	--
2	Distribution of wealth/inequality	--	1	--	--	--	--	1	1	--	--	--
1	Greed	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--
1	Immigration	1	2	2	1	1	1	1	2	6	6	5
1	Financial crisis	--	--	4	4	7	16	26	--	--	--	--
1	Housing market/foreclosures	1	1	2	--	--	--	5	--	--	--	--
1	Social Security	1	--	--	--	1	--	1	--	1	1	1
1	National security	1	1	--	1	1	1	1	3	3	3	1
1	Defense/national security	1	1	--	1	1	1	1	3	3	3	1
1	Jobs moving overseas/Trade	1	1	--	2	1	1	1	1	1	--	--
1	Inflation	2	2	1	--	--	2	5	6	3	1	--
1	Energy costs	7	2	--	--	--	--	5	19	3	2	2
1	Crime/Violence	1	1	--	1	1	1	--	1	1	2	2
1	Drugs/Alcohol	--	1	1	--	--	--	--	--	1	1	1
1	Race relations/Racism	--	--	1	--	--	--	--	1	1	--	--
1	Environment/Pollution/ Global warming	--	1	1	1	--	1	1	3	1	1	1
1	Too much foreign aid/Spend at home	1	--	--	--	--	--	1	--	--	1	--
1	Wall St/Corporate America/banks	--	1	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--
8	Other											
6	Don't know/No answer	7	5	7	6	5	3	4	4	5	5	7
6	**(NET) FOREIGN ISSUES/ INTERNATIONAL**	**9**	**6**	**4**	**11**	**10**	**7**	**18**	**25**	**36**	**48**	**50**
55	**(NET) ECONOMIC**	**68**	**62**	**65**	**65**	**55**	**80**	**75**	**61**	**34**	**20**	**15**

ASK IF ANSWER GIVEN IN Q.12 (Q.12=1) [N=1443]:

Q.13 Which political party do you think can do a better job of handling the problem you just mentioned – the Republican Party or the Democratic Party? **[IF NECESSARY:** thinking about what you see as the most important problem …**]**

	Republican Party	Democratic Party	**(VOL.)** No difference	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	32	38	20	11
Feb 3-9, 2010	31	38	19	12
Aug 27-30, 2009	23	38	28	11
January, 2007	24	42	21	13

[7] Complete trend for Q12 not shown; trends available to 1987.

Q.13 CONTINUED…

	Republican Party	Democratic Party	(VOL.) No difference	(VOL.) DK/Ref
January, 2006	27	41	19	13
January, 2005	36	35	18	11
Mid-January, 2004	35	35	14	16
March, 2002	38	27	21	14
Gallup: January, 1999[8]	33	43	n/a	24
Gallup: April, 1998	40	42	10	8
July, 1996	36	35	18	11
April, 1995	42	32	17	9
July, 1994	36	33	16	15
June, 1993	28	35	23	14
January, 1992	32	41	12	15
May, 1990 *(RVs)*	29	30	31	10
May, 1988	26	38	22	14
January, 1988	30	35	24	11
May, 1987	28	38	24	10

NO QUESTION 14

ASK ALL:

Q.15 From what you've read and heard about the Occupy Wall Street movement involving demonstrations in cities around the country, do you strongly support, somewhat support, somewhat oppose, or strongly oppose the Occupy Wall Street Movement?

	----------Support----------			----------Oppose----------				(VOL.)
	Total	*Strongly*	*Some-what*	Total	*Strongly*	*Some-what*	(VOL.) Neither	DK/ Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	44	*15*	*29*	35	*19*	*16*	6	16
Oct 20-23, 2011[9]	39	*16*	*23*	35	*16*	*19*	6	20

NO QUESTION 16-17

ASK ALL:

REGIST These days, many people are so busy they can't find time to register to vote, or move around so often they don't get a chance to re-register. Are you NOW registered to vote in your precinct or election district or haven't you been able to register so far?
[INSTRUCTION: IF RESPONDENT VOLUNTEERS THAT THEY ARE IN NORTH DAKOTA AND DON'T HAVE TO REGISTER, PUNCH 1 FOR REGIST AND REGICERT]

ASK IF RESPONDENT ANSWERED '1' YES IN REGIST:

REGICERT Are you absolutely certain that you are registered to vote, or is there a chance that your registration has lapsed because you moved or for some other reason?

Dec 7-11 2011	
76	Yes, Registered
72	Absolutely certain
4	Chance registration has lapsed
1	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**
23	No, not registered
1	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

[8] In January 1999, the "no difference" and "don't know" categories are combined.

[9] In October 2011 question read "From what you've read and heard do you strongly support, somewhat support, somewhat oppose, or strongly oppose the Occupy Wall Street movement" and was asked as part of a list.

ASK ALL REGISTERED VOTERS (REGICERT=1):

Thinking about another topic…

Q.18 Would you like to see your representative in Congress be re-elected in the next congressional election, or not?

BASED ON REGISTERED VOTERS [N=1211]:

	Yes	No	(VOL.) Representative not running	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	50	33	1	16
2010 Election				
Oct 27-30, 2010	49	32	2	18
Oct 13-18, 2010	47	32	1	20
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010	49	33	1	17
Jun 16-20, 2010	49	34	1	16
Mar 11-21, 2010	43	32	1	24
Feb 3-9, 2010	49	31	*	19
Oct 28-Nov 8, 2009	52	29	1	18
2008 Election				
Late February, 2008	60	22	1	17
2006 Election				
November, 2006	55	25	1	19
Late October, 2006	55	26	1	18
Early October, 2006	50	27	1	22
September, 2006	53	27	1	19
August, 2006	51	30	*	19
June, 2006	51	32	1	16
April, 2006	57	28	1	14
February, 2006	59	28	1	12
September, 2005	57	25	1	17
2002 Election				
Early October, 2002	58	19	2	21
June, 2002	58	23	1	18
2000 Election				
Early November, 2000	59	16	2	23
October, 2000	60	17	1	22
July, 1999	66	23	*	11
1998 Election				
Late October, 1998	64	19	1	16
Early October, 1998	58	20	2	20
Early September, 1998	63	20	1	16
March, 1998	63	21	1	15
January, 1998	66	23	0	11
August, 1997	66	22	0	12
1996 Election				
Early November, 1996	60	16	3	21
October, 1996	62	19	2	17
Late September, 1996	55	17	2	26
Early September, 1996	62	19	2	17
1994 Election				
November, 1994	58	25	1	16
Late October, 1994	55	30	2	13
Early October, 1994	49	29	2	20
1990 Election				
Gallup: October, 1990	62	22	2	14

ASK ALL REGISTERED VOTERS (REGICERT=1):

Q.19 Regardless of how you feel about your own representative, would you like to see most members of Congress re-elected in the next congressional election, or not?

BASED ON REGISTERED VOTERS [N=1211]:

	Yes	No	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	20	67	13
2010 Election			
Oct 27-30, 2010	35	51	13
Oct 13-18, 2010	33	54	13
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010	33	56	11
Jun 16-20, 2010	31	56	13
Mar 11-21, 2010	27	57	15
Feb 3-9, 2010	32	53	15
Oct 28-Nov 8, 2009	34	53	13
2008 Election			
Late February, 2008	36	49	15
2006 Election			
November, 2006	37	46	17
Late October, 2006	34	49	17
Early October, 2006	32	48	20
September, 2006	35	49	16
August, 2006	36	49	15
June, 2006	29	57	14
April, 2006	34	53	13
February, 2006	36	49	15
September, 2005	36	48	16
2002 Election			
Early October, 2002	39	38	23
June, 2002	45	37	18
2000 Election			
October, 2000	40	34	26
July, 1999	41	47	12
1998 Election			
Late October, 1998	41	37	22
Early October, 1998	39	39	22
Early September, 1998	46	37	17
March, 1998	45	41	14
January, 1998	44	43	13
August, 1997	45	42	13
1996 Election			
Early September, 1996	43	43	14
1994 Election			
November, 1994	31	51	18
Late October, 1994	31	56	13
Early October, 1994	28	56	16

NO QUESTIONS 20-24

ASK ALL:
PARTY In politics TODAY, do you consider yourself a Republican, Democrat, or independent?
ASK IF INDEP/NO PREF/OTHER/DK/REF (PARTY=3,4,5,9):
PARTYLN As of today do you lean more to the Republican Party or more to the Democratic Party?

	Republican	Democrat	Independent	(VOL.) No preference	(VOL.) Other party	(VOL.) DK/Ref	*Lean Rep*	*Lean Dem*
Dec 7-11, 2011	23	33	38	3	*	2	12	17
Nov 9-14, 2011	24	33	38	3	1	2	16	15
Sep 22-Oct 4, 2011	23	33	38	2	1	3	18	16
Aug 17-21, 2011	24	30	40	3	*	3	17	18
Jul 20-24, 2011	24	32	38	4	*	2	16	14
Jun 15-19, 2011	26	34	32	4	*	4	13	13
May 25-30, 2011	24	33	38	3	*	2	15	17
Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	25	32	37	3	*	3	17	16
Mar 8-14, 2011	24	33	38	3	*	2	17	15
Feb 22-Mar 1, 2011	24	33	37	3	*	3	15	16
Feb 2-7, 2011	24	31	39	3	*	2	16	16
Jan 5-9, 2011	27	32	35	4	*	2	15	14
Yearly Totals								
2010	25.2	32.7	35.2	3.6	.4	2.8	14.5	14.1
2009	23.9	34.4	35.1	3.4	.4	2.8	13.1	15.7
2008	25.7	36.0	31.5	3.6	.3	3.0	10.6	15.2
2007	25.3	32.9	34.1	4.3	.4	2.9	10.9	17.0
2006	27.8	33.1	30.9	4.4	.3	3.4	10.5	15.1
2005	29.3	32.8	30.2	4.5	.3	2.8	10.3	14.9
2004	30.0	33.5	29.5	3.8	.4	3.0	11.7	13.4
2003	30.3	31.5	30.5	4.8	.5	2.5	12.0	12.6
2002	30.4	31.4	29.8	5.0	.7	2.7	12.4	11.6
2001	29.0	33.2	29.5	5.2	.6	2.6	11.9	11.6
2001 Post-Sept 11	*30.9*	*31.8*	*27.9*	*5.2*	*.6*	*3.6*	*11.7*	*9.4*
2001 Pre-Sept 11	*27.3*	*34.4*	*30.9*	*5.1*	*.6*	*1.7*	*12.1*	*13.5*
2000	28.0	33.4	29.1	5.5	.5	3.6	11.6	11.7
1999	26.6	33.5	33.7	3.9	.5	1.9	13.0	14.5
1998	27.9	33.7	31.1	4.6	.4	2.3	11.6	13.1
1997	28.0	33.4	32.0	4.0	.4	2.3	12.2	14.1
1996	28.9	33.9	31.8	3.0	.4	2.0	12.1	14.9
1995	31.6	30.0	33.7	2.4	.6	1.3	15.1	13.5
1994	30.1	31.5	33.5	1.3	--	3.6	13.7	12.2
1993	27.4	33.6	34.2	4.4	1.5	2.9	11.5	14.9
1992	27.6	33.7	34.7	1.5	0	2.5	12.6	16.5
1991	30.9	31.4	33.2	0	1.4	3.0	14.7	10.8
1990	30.9	33.2	29.3	1.2	1.9	3.4	12.4	11.3
1989	33	33	34	--	--	--	--	--
1987	26	35	39	--	--	--	--	--

ASK ONLY REPUBLICAN/REPUBLICAN LEANING REGISTERED VOTERS (REGICERT=1 AND (PARTY=1 OR PARTYLN=1)):

Q.25 As I name some possible Republican candidates for president in 2012, please tell me which one, if any, you would most like to see nominated as the Republican Party's candidate? **[READ AND RANDOMIZE] [PROBE IF NECESSARY:** As of today, who would you say you LEAN toward?**]**

IF NAMED CANDIDATE GIVEN (1 thru 7 in Q.25) ASK:

Q.25a Do you support **[INSERT LAST NAME OF CANDIDATE FROM Q.25]** strongly or only moderately?

BASED ON REP/REP-LEANING REGISTERED VOTERS [N=504]:

Dec 7-11 2011		Nov 9-14 2011	Sep 22-Oct 4 2011	Jul 20-24 2011	Mar 8-14 2011	Nov 4-7 2010
33	**Newt Gingrich**	16	7	3	11	9
10	Strongly					
24	Only moderately/DK					
21	**Mitt Romney**	23	21	21	21	17
7	Strongly					
14	Only moderately/DK					
8	**Ron Paul**	8	11	9	8	10
2	Strongly					
6	Only moderately/DK					
6	**Michele Bachmann**	5	4	11	--	--
3	Strongly					
2	Only moderately/DK					
4	**Rick Perry**	8	16	12	--	--
2	Strongly					
3	Only moderately/DK					
3	**Rick Santorum**	2	2	1	2	2
1	Strongly					
1	Only moderately/DK					
3	**Jon Huntsman**	1	1	2	--	--
1	Strongly					
1	Only moderately/DK					
*	Other **(VOL.)** [10]	*	1	1	1	5
--	Herman Cain	22	12	8	--	--
--	Sarah Palin	--	9	11	13	16
--	Tim Pawlenty	--	--	3	3	5
--	Mike Huckabee	--	--	--	20	19
--	Mitch Daniels	--	--	--	2	--
--	Haley Barbour	--	--	--	2	2
--	Chris Christie	--	--	--	2	--
10	None **(VOL.)**	4	5	5	5	4
4	Too early to tell **(VOL.)**	5	5	7	3	--
7	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	5	5	8	7	10

[10] Cain, Palin, Pawlenty, Huckabee, Daniels and Barbour were explicitly asked in some previous surveys. Chris Christie was never asked in any surveys. In surveys in which they received less than 1% support, these responses are included in other. Dashes indicate that candidates were not explicitly asked about and received less than 1% support.

ASK ONLY REPUBLICAN/REPUBLICAN LEANING REGISTERED VOTERS WHO CHOSE A CANDIDATE IN Q25 (REGICERT=1 AND Q25=1-7 AND (PARTY=1 OR PARTYLN=1)):

Q.26 If **[INSERT NAME CHOSEN IN Q25]** were not in the race, is there a chance that you would vote for **[INSERT NAME; RANDOMIZE]** in your state's Republican primary or caucus, or not? What about **[NEXT NAME]**? **[IF NECESSARY:** Is there a chance that you would vote for **[NAME]** in your state's Republican primary, or not?**]** [11]

ASK ONLY REPUBLICAN/REPUBLICAN LEANING REGISTERED VOTERS WHO DID NOT CHOOSE A CANDIDATE IN Q25 (REGICERT=1 AND Q25=9-99 (PARTY=1 OR PARTYLN=1)):

Q.27 Is there a chance that you would vote for **[INSERT NAME; RANDOMIZE]** in your state's Republican primary or caucus, or not? What about **[NEXT NAME]**? **[IF NECESSARY:** Is there a chance that you would vote for **[NAME]** in your state's Republican primary, or not?**]**

BASED ON REP/REP-LEANING REGISTERED VOTERS [N=504]:

		Yes, a chance	No, not a chance	(VOL.) Not planning to vote in primary	(VOL.) DK/Ref	*Candidate was first choice*
a.	Mitt Romney					
	Dec 7-11, 2011	39	26	*	14	*21*
b.	Newt Gingrich					
	Dec 7-11, 2011	34	20	*	13	*33*

NO ITEM c

d.	Rick Perry					
	Dec 7-11, 2011	32	46	*	18	*4*
e.	Ron Paul					
	Dec 7-11, 2011	23	51	*	18	*8*
f.	Michele Bachmann					
	Dec 7-11, 2011	28	51	*	15	*6*
g.	Jon Huntsman					
	Dec 7-11, 2011	19	51	*	27	*3*
h.	Rick Santorum					
	Dec 7-11, 2011	23	46	*	28	*3*

ASK ONLY REPUBLICAN/REPUBLICAN LEANING REGISTERED VOTERS (REGICERT=1 AND (PARTY=1 OR PARTYLN=1)):

Q.28 If there is a Republican primary election or caucus in your state early next year, how likely is it that you will vote? Are you very likely, somewhat likely, not too likely or not at all likely to vote in the Republican primaries?

BASED ON REP/REP-LEANING REGISTERED VOTERS [N=504]:

	Very likely	Somewhat likely	Not too likely	Not at all likely	(VOL.) No primary	(VOL.) Not eligible	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	75	14	4	3	0	3	1

[11] Respondents were not asked about the candidate they picked in Q.25; they were asked this question about all other candidates. Respondents who did not pick a named candidate in Q.25 were asked Q.27 about all candidates.

ASK ONLY REPUBLICAN/REPUBLICAN LEANING REGISTERED VOTERS (REGICERT=1 AND (PARTY=1 OR PARTYLN=1)):

Q.29 Apart from who you would like to see nominated, which Republican candidate do you think has the best chance of defeating Barack Obama next November? **[OPEN END; RECORD FIRST MENTION ONLY.] [IF PERSON OFFERS MULTIPLE CANDIDATES, PROBE WITH:** Which of those do you think has the best chance of defeating Obama?**]**

BASED ON REP/REP-LEANING REGISTERED VOTERS [N=504]:

Dec 7-11 2011		Nov 9-14 2011	Aug 17-21 2011[12]
35	Newt Gingrich	13	4
28	Mitt Romney	30	22
2	Rick Perry	6	28
2	Ron Paul	2	3
1	Jon Huntsman	*	1
1	Michele Bachmann	1	7
1	Rick Santorum	0	1
0	Herman Cain	18	3
0	Sarah Palin	0	9
*	Other	2	1
1	All	1	0
4	None	4	3
25	Don't know/Refused	21	19

RANDOMIZE Q.30/Q.31 IN BLOCK WITH Q.32/Q.33 BLOCK
ASK ALL:

Thinking now about your own personal finances...

Q.30 How would you rate your own personal financial situation? Would you say you are in excellent shape, good shape, only fair shape or poor shape financially?

	Excellent	Good	Only fair	Poor	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	6	32	37	24	1
Jun 15-19, 2011	5	33	40	21	1
Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	7	29	36	26	2
Feb 2-7, 2011	7	29	41	22	1
Dec 1-5, 2010	5	30	40	23	2
Oct 13-18, 2010	6	33	36	23	1
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010	6	30	40	23	1
Jun 3-6, 2010	6	32	38	20	4
Mar 10-14, 2010	6	31	39	22	2
Dec 9-13, 2009	7	28	39	24	2
Oct 28-Nov 8, 2009	5	30	40	25	1
Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	6	32	38	22	1
Aug 11-17, 2009	6	31	36	26	2
Jun 10-14, 2009	6	32	39	22	1
Feb 4-8, 2009	5	33	41	20	1
December, 2008	6	32	40	21	1
Early October, 2008	6	35	40	18	1
July, 2008	9	33	37	19	2
April, 2008	8	35	39	16	2
March, 2008	8	39	34	17	2
Early February, 2008	9	36	37	16	2
January, 2008	10	39	34	15	2
November, 2007	9	41	34	15	1
September, 2007	10	38	34	16	2
February, 2007	8	41	36	14	1
December, 2006	8	40	35	16	1
Late October, 2006	9	40	33	16	2

[12] In August 2011, question began "Apart from your opinions about the Republican candidates, which one…"

Q.30 CONTINUED…

	Excellent	Good	Only fair	Poor	(VOL.) DK/Ref
March, 2006	9	39	36	15	1
January, 2006	7	39	37	15	2
Mid-May, 2005	7	37	39	16	1
January, 2005	10	41	34	14	1
August, 2004	9	42	34	14	1
September, 2003	10	38	36	15	1
Late March, 2003	10	43	31	12	4
January, 2003	7	38	39	15	1
Early October, 2002	7	39	37	16	1
June, 2002	5	40	37	16	2
Late September, 2001	7	40	37	14	2
June, 2001	6	38	39	16	1
June, 2000	9	43	35	11	2
August, 1999	6	43	41	9	1
May, 1997	7	43	38	11	1
September, 1996 *(RVs)*	8	47	34	10	1
February, 1995	8	39	38	14	1
March, 1994	5	41	40	13	1
December, 1993	5	34	45	15	1
*U.S. News:*January, 1993	4	33	46	16	1
*U.S. News:*October, 1992	6	34	40	19	1
*U.S. News:*August, 1992	5	30	47	17	1
*U.S. News:*May, 1992	4	35	45	15	1
*U.S. News:*January, 1992	4	32	45	18	1

RANDOMIZE Q.30/Q.31 IN BLOCK WITH Q.32/Q.33 BLOCK
ASK ALL:

Q.31 Over the course of the next year, do you think the financial situation of you and your family will improve a lot, improve some, get a little worse or get a lot worse?

	Improve a lot	Improve some	Get a little worse	Get a lot worse	(VOL.) Stay the same	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	9	49	17	5	15	4
Jun 15-19, 2011	7	49	21	7	13	3
Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	7	44	23	10	13	3
Dec 1-5, 2010	7	49	20	6	14	4
Oct 13-18, 2010	9	48	16	6	17	5
Mar 10-14, 2010	9	52	15	8	12	4
Dec 9-13, 2009	9	44	19	8	15	4
Oct 28-Nov 8, 2009	6	50	19	8	13	4
Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	10	49	17	6	13	4
Aug 11-17, 2009	8	47	17	8	15	5
Jun 10-14, 2009	9	54	17	7	9	4
Feb 4-8, 2009	7	47	22	7	13	4
December, 2008	7	49	21	6	13	4
Early October, 2008	8	51	20	6	9	6
July, 2008	7	44	21	7	14	7
March, 2008	10	45	20	7	13	5
January, 2008	11	49	16	6	14	4
September, 2007	10	52	14	4	16	4
February, 2007	11	52	12	3	19	3
December, 2006	10	57	13	3	14	3
January, 2006	10	51	14	5	16	4
Mid-May, 2005	10	51	15	5	15	4
January, 2005	10	54	14	4	15	3
August, 2004	13	57	9	3	12	6
September, 2003	11	53	15	4	14	3
Late March, 2003	12	51	15	4	11	7

Q.31 CONTINUED…

	Improve a lot	Improve some	Get a little worse	Get a lot worse	Stay the same	(VOL.) DK/Ref
January, 2003	9	51	18	5	13	4
Early October, 2002	10	54	13	5	12	6
June, 2002	11	55	15	4	11	4
January, 2002	12	53	15	5	11	4
Late September, 2001	9	46	16	4	17	8
June, 2001	11	52	15	4	14	4
January, 2001	11	46	18	9	12	4
January, 1999	17	55	7	3	14	4
May, 1997	12	56	10	2	17	3
February, 1995	11	53	13	3	17	3
March, 1994	10	57	11	3	16	3
U.S. News:October, 1992	9	51	14	3	15	8
U.S. News:August, 1992	6	50	20	5	14	5
U.S. News:May, 1992	8	49	22	4	13	4
U.S. News:January, 1992	9	46	19	5	16	5

RANDOMIZE Q.30/Q.31 IN BLOCK WITH Q.32/Q.33 BLOCK
ASK ALL:

Thinking now about the nation's economy…

Q.32 How would you rate economic conditions in this country today… as excellent, good, only fair, or poor?

	Excellent	Good	Only fair	Poor	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	*	8	38	53	1
Aug 17-21, 2011	1	6	37	56	1
Jun 15-19, 2011	*	8	45	46	1
Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	1	7	38	53	1
Feb 2-7, 2011	1	11	45	42	1
Dec 1-5, 2010	1	8	44	45	1
Oct 13-18, 2010	1	7	38	54	1
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010	1	7	43	48	1
Jun 3-6, 2010	1	8	48	43	1
Apr 21-26, 2010	*	11	39	49	1
Mar 10-14, 2010	1	6	39	53	1
Feb 3-9, 2010	1	7	38	53	1
Dec 9-13, 2009	1	7	41	50	1
Oct 28-Nov 8, 2009	*	8	41	50	1
Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	1	8	43	48	1
Aug 11-17, 2009	*	8	38	52	2
Jun 10-14, 2009	1	8	39	52	1
Mar 9-12, 2009	*	6	25	68	1
Feb 4-8, 2009	*	4	24	71	1
December, 2008	*	7	33	59	1
November, 2008	1	6	28	64	1
Late October, 2008	*	7	25	67	1
Early October, 2008	1	8	32	58	1
Late September, 2008	*	7	27	65	1
July, 2008	1	9	39	50	1
April, 2008	1	10	33	56	*
March, 2008	1	10	32	56	1
Early February, 2008	1	16	36	45	2
January, 2008	3	23	45	28	1
November, 2007	3	20	44	32	1
September, 2007	3	23	43	29	2
June, 2007	6	27	40	25	2
February, 2007	5	26	45	23	1
December, 2006	6	32	41	19	2
Early November, 2006 *(RVs)*	9	35	37	17	2

Q.32 CONTINUED…

	Excellent	Good	Only fair	Poor	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Late October, 2006	6	27	40	25	2
September, 2006	5	32	41	20	2
March, 2006	4	29	44	22	1
January, 2006	4	30	45	19	2
Early October, 2005	2	23	45	29	1
Mid-September, 2005	3	28	44	24	1
Mid-May, 2005	3	29	47	20	1
January, 2005	3	36	45	15	1
December, 2004	3	33	43	20	1
Early November, 2004 (*RVs*)	5	31	37	26	1
Mid-September, 2004	4	34	40	20	2
August, 2004	3	30	45	21	1
Late April, 2004	4	34	38	22	2
Late February, 2004[13]	2	29	42	26	1

RANDOMIZE Q.30/Q.31 IN BLOCK WITH Q.32/Q.33 BLOCK
ASK ALL:

Q.33 A year from now, do you expect that economic conditions in the country as a whole will be better than they are at present, or worse, or just about the same as now?

	Better	Worse	Same	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	28	18	50	4
Aug 17-21, 2011	29	18	50	2
Jun 15-19, 2011	29	23	46	2
Oct 13-18, 2010	35	16	45	4
Apr 21-26, 2010	42	19	36	3
Feb 3-9, 2010	42	16	40	3
Dec 9-13, 2009	42	17	38	3
Oct 28-Nov 8, 2009	39	19	39	2
Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	45	15	38	3
Aug 11-17, 2009	45	19	33	3
Jun 10-14, 2009	48	16	34	2
Mar 9-12, 2009	41	19	37	3
Feb 4-8, 2009	40	18	38	4
December, 2008	43	17	36	4
Early October, 2008	46	16	30	8
July, 2008	30	21	41	8
March, 2008	33	22	39	6
January, 2008	20	26	48	6
September, 2007	19	23	53	5
June, 2007	16	24	55	5
February, 2007	17	20	58	5
December, 2006	22	18	56	4
September, 2006	16	25	55	4
January, 2006	20	22	55	3
Early October, 2005	20	32	45	3
Mid-September, 2005	18	37	43	2
Mid-May, 2005	18	24	55	3
January, 2005	27	18	52	3
August, 2004	36	9	47	8
Late February, 2004	39	12	41	8
September, 2003	37	17	43	3
May, 2003	43	19	35	3
Late March, 2003	33	23	37	7
January, 2003	30	20	44	6
January, 2002	44	17	36	3

[13] Earlier trends available from Gallup.

Q.33 CONTINUED…

	Better	Worse	Same	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Newsweek: January, 2001	18	33	44	5
June, 2000	15	24	55	6
Early October, 1998 *(RVs)*	16	22	57	5
Early September, 1998	18	17	61	4
May, 1990	18	31	45	6
February, 1989	25	22	49	4
September, 1988 *(RVs)*	24	16	51	9
May, 1988	24	20	46	10
January, 1988	22	26	45	7
Newsweek: January, 1984 *(RVs)*	35	13	49	3

ASK ALL:

And a different kind of question…

Q.34 Some people think of American society as divided into two groups, the "haves" and the "have-nots," while others think it's incorrect to think of America that way. Do you, yourself, think of America as divided into haves and have-nots, or don't you think of America that way?

	Yes, divided	No	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	38	58	4
Sep 22-25, 2011	45	52	2
Apr 21-26, 2010	42	53	5
Apr 14-21, 2009	35	62	3
Early October, 2008	44	53	3
January, 2008	43	54	3
July, 2007	48	48	4
September, 2006	41	55	4
Early October, 2005	48	50	2
Late March, 2005	38	59	3
Late February, 2004	38	59	3
June, 2001	44	53	3
Gallup: April, 1998	39	59	2
Gallup: July, 1988	26	71	3
CBS/NY Times: Aug, 1984	31	61	8

ASK ALL:

Q.35 If you had to choose, which of these groups are you in, the haves or the have-nots?

	Haves	Have-nots	(VOL.) Neither	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	46	39	7	9
Sep 22-25, 2011	48	34	11	7
Apr 21-26, 2010	45	36	9	10
Apr 14-21, 2009	48	36	7	9
Early October, 2008	47	38	8	7
January, 2008	50	34	10	6
July, 2007	45	34	13	8
September, 2006	52	29	10	9
Early October, 2005	47	38	11	4
Late March, 2005	48	34	8	10
Late February, 2004	59	27	7	7
June, 2001	52	32	10	6
Gallup: April, 1998	67	24	6	3
Gallup: July, 1988	59	17	15	9

ASK ALL:

Q.36 Now, thinking about some possible economic concerns for the country. First, do you think that **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]** poses a major threat, a minor threat, or no threat to the economic well being of the U.S.? What about **[INSERT ITEM]**? **[IF NECESSARY:** Is **[ITEM]** a major threat, a minor threat, or no threat to the economic well being of the U.S.?**]**

		Major threat	Minor threat	No threat	(VOL.) DK/Ref
a.	Economic problems in Europe				
	Dec 7-11, 2011	46	33	8	13
b.	Economic competition from China				
	Dec 7-11, 2011	59	27	7	7
c.	The power of financial institutions and banks				
	Dec 7-11, 2011	56	29	8	7
d.	The size of the national debt				
	Dec 7-11, 2011	76	16	4	4
e.	Government regulation of business				
	Dec 7-11, 2011	44	34	13	9

NO QUESTIONS 37-40

Next,

ASK ALL:

Q.41 Compared to recent Congresses, would you say THIS Congress has accomplished more, accomplished less, or accomplished about the same amount?

	More	Less	Same amount	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	8	50	37	5
Sep 30-Oct 3, 2010	20	36	37	7
Jun 16-20, 2010	18	33	44	6
October, 2007	5	43	42	10
October, 2006	6	39	47	8
Early September, 2006	7	37	49	7
June, 2006	7	43	42	8
April, 2006	8	38	48	6
Early November, 2002 *(RVs)*	11	27	54	8
June, 2002	16	22	56	6
July, 2000	21	15	55	9
August, 1999	15	20	60	5
Early October, 1998(*RVs*)	24	23	49	4
Early September, 1998	25	15	55	5
Early August, 1998	18	15	60	7
November, 1997	23	12	59	6
April, 1997	10	22	59	9
Gallup:October, 1994	10	36	51	3

[IF "2" IN Q.41, ASK]:

Q.42 Who do you think is most to blame for this **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**

BASED ON THOSE WHO SAY CONGRESS ACCOMPLISHED LESS [N=861]:

	Republican leaders	Democratic leaders	(VOL.) Both	(VOL.) Neither/ Someone else	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	40	23	32	1	3
Jun 16-20, 2010	16	49	28	5	3
October, 2007	30	26	34	5	5

Q.42 CONTINUED…

	Republican leaders	Democratic leaders	(VOL.) Both	(VOL.) Neither/ Someone else	(VOL.) DK/Ref
October, 2006	59	10	21	4	6
June, 2006	56	16	22	2	4
April, 2006	58	13	21	4	4

ASK ALL:

Q.43 Which comes closer to your view of Congress these days? **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**

Dec 7-11 2011		Mar 11-21 2010
32	Most members of Congress have good intentions, it's the political system that is broken	38
55	The political system can work fine, it's the members of Congress that are the problem	52
6	Both **(VOL.)**	3
1	Neither **(VOL.)**	1
7	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	6

ASK ALL:

Q.44 I'm going to read you some pairs of statements. As I read each pair, tell me whether the FIRST statement or the SECOND statement comes closer to your own views — even if neither is exactly right. The first pair is… **[READ AND RANDOMIZE PAIRS BUT NOT STATEMENTS WITHIN EACH PAIR].** The next pair is **[NEXT PAIR]**…

a.	Most people who want to get ahead can make it if they're willing to work hard	Hard work and determination are no guarantee of success for most people	(VOL.) Neither/DK
Dec 7-11, 2011	58	40	3
Feb 22-Mar 14, 2011	62	34	4
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010 *(RVs)*	64	33	3
March, 2006	64	33	3
December, 2005	64	33	3
December, 2004	68	28	4
September, 2000	73	24	3
August, 1999	74	23	3
July, 1994	68	30	2

NO ITEM b

c.	As Americans, we can always find ways to solve our problems and get what we want	This country can't solve many of its important problems	(VOL.) Neither/DK
Dec 7-11, 2011	60	36	3
Feb 22-Mar 1, 2011	57	37	6
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010 *(RVs)*	54	42	5
December, 2008	68	27	5
October, 2008	64	29	7
December, 2004	59	36	5
September, 2000	59	36	5
August, 1999	63	32	5
July, 1994	52	45	3

d.	Wall Street helps the American economy more than it hurts	Wall Street hurts the American economy more than it helps	(VOL.) Neither/DK
Dec 7-11, 2011	36	51	13
Mar 8-14, 2011	38	47	15

Q.44 CONTINUED…

e.	The economic system in this country unfairly favors the wealthy	The economic system in this country is generally fair to most Americans	**(VOL.)** Neither/DK
Dec 7-11, 2011	61	36	3

Next…

ASK ALL:

Q.45 Do you think there is too much power in the hands of a few rich people and large corporations in the United States, or don't you think so?

Dec 7-11 2011		*Gallup* April 1941[14]
77	Yes, think a few rich people and corporations have too much power	60
19	No, do not think a few rich people and corporations have too much power	26
4	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	14

Thinking about the political parties …

ASK ALL:

Q.46 Please tell me if you think each phrase I read better describes the REPUBLICAN Party and its leaders or the DEMOCRATIC Party and its leaders (First,) which party do you think is better described by the phrase… **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE.]** Which party **[NEXT ITEM]**?

		Republican Party	Democratic Party	**(VOL.)** Both equally	**(VOL.)** Neither	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a.	Is more extreme in its positions					
	Dec 7-11, 2011	53	33	4	1	9
	Sep 22-Oct 4, 2011	50	38	3	1	7
	Jul 20-24, 2011	50	35	4	2	9
b.	Is more willing to work with political leaders from the other party					
	Dec 7-11, 2011	25	51	3	12	10
	Jul 20-24, 2011	26	51	1	12	9
	Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	32	49	2	10	6
c.	Can better manage the federal government					
	Dec 7-11, 2011	35	41	3	13	9
	Jul 20-24, 2011	40	38	2	14	7
	Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	41	39	2	8	9
	Oct 13-18, 2010	43	36	2	11	8
	Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010	41	41	3	8	7
	Jun 16-20, 2010	41	37	3	12	7
	Feb 3-9, 2010	40	40	4	9	8
	Aug 27-30, 2009	34	38	4	14	10
	October, 2007	32	44	5	9	10
	March, 2007	31	47	3	8	11
	Early October, 2006	34	44	3	9	10
	April, 2006[15]	35	39	3	15	8
	January, 2006	34	40	4	12	10
	Early October, 2005	35	41	3	13	8
	July, 2004	37	40	4	9	10
	Early September, 1998	37	32	8	12	11
	August, 1997	39	33	4	16	8
	July, 1996	45	32	4	12	7
	April, 1995	49	30	3	13	5

[14] In April 1941, question read "Do you think there is too much power in the hands of a few rich men and large corporations in the United States?"

[15] In April 2006 and earlier, the item was worded: "Able to manage the federal government well."

Q.46 CONTINUED…

	Republican Party	Democratic Party	(VOL.) Both equally	(VOL.) Neither	(VOL.) DK/Ref
July, 1994	43	31	4	17	5
May, 1993	36	32	2	17	13
July, 1992	30	36	1	23	10
May, 1990	28	20	12	31	9
May, 1988	33	30	10	17	10
January, 1988	30	28	12	20	10
May, 1987	24	25	13	28	10
d. Governs in a more honest and ethical way					
Dec 7-11, 2011	28	45	2	16	9
Jul 20-24, 2011	30	42	2	20	7
Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	33	42	3	14	8
Oct 13-18, 2010	35	35	4	16	9
Jun 16-20, 2010	31	41	4	18	6
August 27-30, 2009	26	42	4	20	9
October, 2007	26	40	6	19	9
March, 2007	25	43	4	18	10
Early October, 2006	27	41	4	18	10
April, 2006[16]	28	36	4	23	9
January, 2006	30	37	4	19	10
Early October, 2005	30	40	6	18	6
July, 2004	34	37	5	15	9
Early September, 1998	31	28	6	23	12
March, 1998	28	32	7	24	9
August, 1997	28	33	5	26	8
July, 1996	38	37	2	18	5
April, 1995	35	36	4	19	6
July, 1994	32	35	6	21	6

NO QUESTION 47

On a different subject…
ASK ALL:
Q.48 As I read a list of words, please tell me what your reaction is to each … (First,) do you have a positive or negative reaction to the word… **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**? How about **[NEXT ITEM]**? **[IF NECESSARY**: do you have a positive or negative reaction to the word **(REPEAT ITEM)]**

	Positive	Negative	(VOL.) Neither/ Neutral	(VOL.) DK/Ref
a. Socialism				
Dec 7-11, 2011	31	60	3	6
Apr 21-26, 2010	29	59	6	5
b. Progressive				
Dec 7-11, 2011	67	22	3	8
Apr 21-26, 2010	68	23	4	6
c. Libertarian				
Dec 7-11, 2011	38	37	7	17
Apr 21-26, 2010	38	37	9	16
d. Capitalism				
Dec 7-11, 2011	50	40	3	7
Apr 21-26, 2010	52	37	4	7

[16] In April 2006 and earlier, the item was worded: "Governs in an honest and ethical way."

Q.48 CONTINUED…

	Positive	Negative	(VOL.) Neither/ Neutral	(VOL.) DK/Ref
e. Liberal				
Dec 7-11, 2011	50	39	5	6
f. Conservative				
Dec 7-11, 2011	62	30	4	4

Now thinking about taxes…

ASK ALL:

Q.49 How fair do you think our present federal tax system is? Overall would you say that our tax system is **[READ IN ORDER]**

	Very fair	Moderately fair	Not too fair	Not fair at all	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Dec 7-11, 2011	3	40	31	24	3
CNN: Apr 9-11, 2011	4	45	30	20	1
NPR/Kaiser/Harvard: March 2003	4	47	32	16	1
Time/CNN: March 1997	3	42	31	23	2
Time/CNN: May 1985	2	41	31	24	2

ASK ALL:

Q.50 Considering what you get from the federal government, do you think you pay more than your fair share of taxes, less than your fair share, or about the right amount?

		TREND FOR COMPARISON:			
			NPR/Kaiser/Harvard		
Dec 7-11 2011		Mar 11-21 2010	May 2000[17]	Feb 2000	Oct 1997
38	More than fair share	43	55	55	52
5	Less than fair share	3	2	1	2
52	About the right amount	50	42	41	45
5	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	3	1	3	1

ASK ALL:

Q.51 Which of the following statements comes closest to expressing your overall view of the federal tax system in this country **[READ]**

		NPR/Kaiser/Harvard
Dec 7-11 2011		March 2003
34	On the whole, the federal tax system works pretty well and Congress should make only minor changes to make it work better	44
59	There is so much wrong with the federal tax system that Congress should completely change it	52
7	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	3

[17] May 2000 survey by National Public Radio, Henry J. Kaiser Family Foundation, Harvard University's Kennedy School of Government. The question read, "Considering what you get from the FEDERAL government, do you think you pay more than your fair share of federal taxes, less than your fair share, or about your fair share?"

ASK ALL:
Q.52 Which of the following bothers you most about taxes **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**

Dec 7-11 2011		*NPR/Kaiser/Harvard* March 2003
11	The large amount you pay in taxes	14
28	The complexity of the tax system	32
57	The feeling that some wealthy people get away not paying their fair share	51
4	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	2

ASK ALL:
TEAPARTY2 From what you know, do you agree or disagree with the Tea Party movement, or don't you have an opinion either way?

	Agree	Disagree	No opinion either way	**(VOL.)** Haven't heard of	**(VOL.)** Refused	*Not heard of/ DK*
Dec 7-11, 2011	19	27	50	2	2	--
Nov 9-14, 2011	20	27	51	1	1	--
Sep 22-Oct 4, 2011	19	27	51	2	1	--
Aug 17-21, 2011	20	27	50	1	1	--
Jul 20-24, 2011	20	24	53	1	1	--
Jun 15-19, 2011	20	26	50	3	2	--
May 25-30, 2011	18	23	54	2	2	--
Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	22	29	47	1	1	--
Mar 8-14, 2011	19	25	54	1	1	--
Feb 22-Mar 1, 2011	20	25	52	2	2	--
Feb 2-7, 2011[18]	22	22	53	2	2	--
Jan 5-9, 2011	24	22	50	2	1	--
Dec 1-5, 2010	22	26	49	2	2	--
Nov 4-7, 2010	27	22	49	1	1	--
Oct 27-30, 2010 *(RVs)*	29	25	32	--	1	*13*
Oct 13-18, 2010 *(RVs)*	28	24	30	--	1	*16*
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010 *(RVs)*	29	26	32	--	1	*13*
Jul 21-Aug 5, 2010	22	18	37	--	1	*21*
Jun 16-20, 2010	24	18	30	--	*	*27*
May 20-23, 2010	25	18	31	--	1	*25*
Mar 11-21, 2010	24	14	29	--	1	*31*

[18] In the February 2-7, 2011 survey and before, question read "…do you strongly agree, agree, disagree or strongly disagree with the Tea Party movement…"In October 2010 and earlier, question was asked only of those who had heard or read a lot or a little about the Tea Party. In May through October, it was described as: "the Tea Party movement that has been involved in campaigns and protests in the U.S. over the past year." In March it was described as "the Tea Party protests that have taken place in the U.S. over the past year."